

2 Subject content and assessment information

Qualification aims and objectives

The aims and objectives of this qualification are to enable students to:

- develop knowledge and an informed understanding of contemporary political structures and issues in their historical context, both within the United Kingdom (UK) and globally
- develop a critical awareness of the changing nature of politics and the relationships between political ideas, institutions and processes
- develop knowledge and an informed understanding of the influences and interests which have an impact on decisions in government and politics
- develop knowledge and an informed understanding of the rights and responsibilities of individuals and groups
- develop the ability to critically analyse, interpret and evaluate political information to form arguments and make judgements
- develop an interest in, and engagement with, contemporary politics.

Component 1: UK Politics and Core Political Ideas

There are two compulsory sections to this component: UK Politics and Core Political Ideas.

UK Politics

This section explores the nature of politics and how people engage in the political process in the UK.

Students will investigate in detail how people and politics interact. They will explore the emergence and development of the UK's democratic system and the similarities, differences, connections and parallels between direct and indirect democracy. They will focus on the role and scope of political parties that are so central to contemporary politics, including the significance of the manifestos they publish at election time and their relevance to the mandate of the resulting government.

This section allows students to understand the individual in the political process and their relationship with the state and their fellow citizens. Students will examine how electoral systems in the UK operate and how individuals and groups are influenced in their voting behaviour and political actions. This component will further examine the role of the media in contemporary politics. It will also give students an understanding of voting patterns and voting behaviour.

There are four content areas in UK Politics:

1. Democracy and participation
2. Political parties
3. Electoral systems
4. Voting behaviour and the media.

Core Political Ideas

This section allows students to explore the three traditional political ideas of conservatism, liberalism and socialism. Students will learn about the core ideas and principles and how they apply in practice to human nature, the state, society and the economy, the divisions within each idea and their key thinkers.

There are three content areas in Core Political Ideas:

1. Liberalism
2. Conservatism
3. Socialism.

Skills

- Students must comprehend and interpret political information in relation to areas of UK politics and core political ideas.
- Students must fully understand, and critically analyse and evaluate areas of UK politics and core political ideas.
- Students must identify parallels, connections, similarities and differences between content studied, providing a basis for comparing the UK with the USA and appreciating the UK's position in global politics.
- Students must construct and communicate arguments and explanations with relevance, clarity and coherence, and draw reasoned conclusions about UK politics and core political ideas.
- Students must develop knowledge and understanding of key political concepts. The content supports these skills by presenting the main content for learning in the right-hand side of the content tables.
- Students must use appropriate vocabulary. The content supports this skill by listing key terminology in each content area in the left-hand side of the content table. The lists are to support teaching of the main content and help students to use appropriate vocabulary in assessment. Students should, therefore, familiarise themselves with the definitions of key terminology for each section, please also see *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

UK Politics content

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
1 Democracy and participation	1.1 Current systems of representative democracy and direct democracy. • The features of direct democracy and representative democracy. • The similarities and differences between direct democracy and representative democracy. Advantages and disadvantages of direct democracy and representative democracy and consideration of the case for reform.
Key terminology	
Legitimacy Direct democracy Representative democracy Pluralist democracy Democratic deficit Participation crisis Franchise/suffrage Think tanks Lobbyists	1.2 A wider franchise and debates over suffrage. • Key milestones in the widening of the franchise in relation to class, gender, ethnicity and age, including the 1832 Great Reform Act and the 1918, 1928 and 1969 Representation of the People Acts. • The work of the suffragists/suffragettes to extend the franchise. The work of a current movement to extend the franchise.
	1.3 Pressure groups and other influences. • How different pressure groups exert influence and how their methods and influence vary in contemporary politics. • Case studies of two different pressure groups, highlighting examples of how their methods and influence vary. • Other collective organisations and groups including think tanks, lobbyists and corporations, and their influence on government and Parliament.
	1.4 Rights in context. • Major milestones in their development, including the significance of Magna Carta and more recent developments, including the Human Rights Act 1998 and Equality Act 2010. • Debates on the extent, limits and tensions within the UK's rights-based culture, including consideration of how individual and collective right may conflict, the contributions from civil liberties pressure groups – including the work of two contemporary civil liberties pressure groups.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
2 Political parties <i>Key terminology</i> Old Labour (social democracy) New Labour (Third Way) One Nation New Right Classical liberals Modern liberals Party systems Left-wing Right-wing	2.1 Political parties. • The functions and features of political parties in the UK's representative democracy. • How parties are currently funded and debates on the consequences of the current funding system.
	2.2 Established political parties. • The origins and historical development of the Conservative Party, the Labour Party and Liberal Democrat Party, and how this has shaped their ideas and current policies on the economy, law and order, welfare and foreign affairs.
	2.3 Emerging and minor UK political parties. • The importance of other parties in the UK. • The ideas and policies of two other minor parties.
	2.4 UK political parties in context. • The development of a multi-party system and its implications for government. • Various factors that affect party success – explanations of why political parties have succeeded or failed, including debates on the influence of the media.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
3 Electoral systems	3.1 Different electoral systems. - First-past-the-post (FPTP), Additional Member System (AMS), Single Transferable Vote (STV), and Supplementary Vote (SV). - The advantages and disadvantages of these different systems. - Comparison of first-past-the-post (FPTP) to a different electoral system in a devolved parliament/assembly.
Key terminology	
First-past-the-post (FPTP)	
Additional Member System (AMS)	
Single Transferable Vote (STV)	3.2 Referendums and how they are used. - How referendums have been used in the UK and their impact on UK political life since 1997. - The case for and against referendums in a representative democracy.
Supplementary Vote (SV)	
Safe seat	
Marginal seat	3.3 Electoral system analysis. - Debates on why different electoral systems are used in the UK. - The impact of the electoral system on the government or type of government appointed. - The impact of different systems on party representation and of electoral systems on voter choice.
Minority government	
Coalition government	

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
4 Voting behaviour and the media Key terminology Class dealignment Partisan dealignment Governing competency Disillusion and apathy Manifesto Mandate	4.1 Case studies of three key general elections. • Case studies of three elections (one from the period 1945–92, the 1997 election, and one since 1997), the results and their impact on parties and government. • The factors that explain the outcomes of these elections, including: - o the reasons for and impact of party policies and manifestos, techniques used in their election campaigns, and the wider political context of the elections - o class-based voting and other factors influencing voting patterns, such as partisanship and voting attachment - o gender, age, ethnicity and region as factors in influencing voting behaviour, turnout and trends. • Analysis of the national voting-behaviour patterns for these elections, revealed by national data sources and how and why they vary. 4.2 The influence of the media. • The Assessment of the role and impact of the media on politics – both during and between key general elections, including the importance and relevance of opinion polls, media bias and persuasion.

Definitions of key terminology are given in *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

Core Political Ideas content

Conservatism

Conservatism seeks to conserve society as it is and is suspicious of change. Conservatism values pragmatism over ideological thinking, seeking to adapt its values over time, according to changes in society. However, new right thinking within conservatism in the 1970s and 1980s challenged much of what conservatism had traditionally stood for.

There are three content areas:

1. Conservatism: core ideas and principles
2. Differing views and tensions within conservatism
3. Conservative thinkers and their ideas.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
1 Conservatism: core ideas and principles	Core ideas and principles of conservatism and how they relate to human nature, the state, society and the economy:
Key terminology	
Hierarchy	• pragmatism – flexible approach to society with decisions made on the basis of what works – to cover links between pragmatism and traditional conservative and one-nation philosophy
Authority	• tradition – accumulated wisdom of past societies and a connection between the generations – to cover how this creates stability, links with organic change, and enhances humans’ security
Change to conserve	• human imperfection – humans are flawed which makes them incapable of making good decisions for themselves – to cover the three aspects of psychological, moral and intellectual imperfection
Atomism	• organic society/state – society/state is more important than any individual parts – to cover how this links to the underpinning of the beliefs of authority and hierarchy, and a cohesive society • paternalism – benign power exerted from above by the state, that governs in the interests of the people – to cover the different interpretations by traditional (an authoritarian approach, the state knows what is best so the people must do what they are told) and one-nation conservatives (there is an obligation on the wealthy to look after those who are unable to look after themselves) and why it is rejected by New Right Conservatives • libertarianism (specifically neo-liberalism) – upholds liberty, seeking to maximise autonomy and free choice, mainly in the economy – to cover the moral and economic values associated with this idea.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
2 Differing views and tensions within conservatism <i>Key terminology</i> Noblesse oblige Anti-permissiveness Radical Human imperfection	The differing views and tensions within conservatism: • traditional conservative – commitment to hierarchical and paternalistic values • one-nation conservative – updating of traditional conservatism in response to the emergence of capitalism • New Right – the marriage of neo-liberal and neo-conservative ideas and include: - o neo-liberal: principally concerned with free-market economics and atomistic individualism - o neo-conservative: principally concerned with the fear of social fragmentation, tough on law and order and public morality.

Please note that content area 3 should focus on the key ideas given, rather than on the study of biographical information on each thinker.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
3 Conservative thinkers and their ideas <i>Key terminology</i> Laissez-faire Empiricism	The key ideas of the following thinkers to exemplify the content from areas 1 and 2: Thomas Hobbes (1588–1679) • Order – an ordered society should balance the human need to lead a free life. • Human nature – humans are needy, vulnerable and easily led astray in attempts to understand the world around them. Edmund Burke (1729–1797) • Change – political change should be undertaken with great caution and organically. • Tradition and empiricism – practices passed down for generations should be respected. Michael Oakeshott (1901–1990) • Human imperfection – suggestion that society is unpredictable and humans are imperfect. • Pragmatism – belief that conservatism is about being pragmatic. Ayn Rand (1905–1982) • Objectivism – this advocates the virtues of rational self-interest. • Freedom – this supports a pure, laissez-faire capitalist economy. Robert Nozick (1938–2002) • Libertarianism – based on Kant’s idea that individuals in society cannot be treated as a thing, or used against their will as a resource. • Self-ownership – individuals own their bodies, talents, abilities and labour.

Please note that content area 3 should focus on the key ideas given, rather than on the study of detailed biographical information on each thinker. Key terminology is not exclusive to the given content area and they apply across all three content areas. Definitions of key terminology are given in *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

Liberalism

Liberalism is seen essentially as a product of The Enlightenment as it recognises that humans are rational creatures capable of understanding the world and making decisions for themselves. The defining feature of liberalism is its belief in individualism and freedom.

There are three content areas:

1. Liberalism: core ideas and principles
2. Differing views and tensions within liberalism
3. Liberal thinkers and their ideas.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
1 Liberalism: core ideas and principles	Core ideas and principles of liberalism and how they relate to human nature, the state, society and the economy:
Key terminology	
Foundational equality	• individualism – the primacy of the individual in society over any group – to cover egoistical individualism and developmental individualism
Formal equality	• freedom/liberty – the ability and right to make decisions in your own interests based on your view of human nature – to cover how liberals guarantee individual freedom, the link between freedom and individualism, that freedom is 'under the law'
Equality of opportunity	
Social contract	• state – it is 'necessary' to avoid disorder, but 'evil' as it has potential to remove individual liberty, thus should be limited; this is linked to the liberal view of the economy
Meritocracy	• rationalism – the belief that humans are rational creatures, capable of reason and logic – to cover how rationalism underpins an individual's ability to define their own best interests and make their own moral choices, creating a progressive society
Mechanistic theory	
Tolerance	• equality/social justice – the belief that individuals are of equal value and that they should be treated impartially and fairly by society – to cover foundational and formal equality, and equality of opportunity
Limited government	• liberal democracy – a democracy that balances the will of the people, as shown through elections, with limited government (state) and a respect for civil liberties in society – to cover why liberals support it as well as why they are concerned about it.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
2 Differing views and tensions within liberalism <i>Key terminology</i> Egoistical individualism Developmental individualism Negative freedom Positive freedom Laissez-faire capitalism Keynesianism	The differing views and tensions within liberalism: • classical liberalism – early liberals who believed that individual freedom would best be achieved with the state playing a minimal role • modern liberalism – emerged as a reaction against free-market capitalism, believing this had led to many individuals not being free. Freedom could no longer simply be defined as 'being left alone'.

Please note that content area 3 should focus on the key ideas given, rather than on the study of detailed biographical information on each thinker.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
3 Liberal thinkers and their ideas Key terminology Harm principle Minimal state Enabling state	The key ideas of the following thinkers to exemplify the content from areas 1 and 2: John Locke (1632-1704) • Social contract theory – society, state and government are based on a theoretical voluntary agreement. • Limited government – that government should be limited and based on consent from below. Mary Wollstonecraft (1759-97) • Reason – women are rational and independent beings capable of reason. • Formal equality – in order to be free, women should enjoy full civil liberties and be allowed to have a career. John Stuart Mill (1806-73) • Harm principle – that individuals should be free to do anything except harm other individuals. • Tolerance – belief that the popularity of a view does not necessarily make it correct. John Rawls (1921-2002) • Theory of justice – opinion that society must be just and guarantee each citizen a life worth living. • The veil of ignorance – a hypothetical scenario where individuals agree on the type of society they want from a position where they lack knowledge of their own position in society. Betty Friedan (1921-2006) • Legal equality – women are as capable as men and that oppressive laws and social views must be overturned. • Equal opportunity – women are being held back from their potential because of the limited number of jobs that are 'acceptable' for women.

Please note that key terminology is not exclusive to the given content area and applies across all three content areas. Definitions of key terminology are given in *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

Socialism

Socialism is defined by its opposition to capitalism. It aims to provide a clear alternative that is more humane and based on collectivism not individualism, co-operation not competition and social equality not inequality. There is a wide variety of traditions within socialism, with the goal of abolishing or minimising class division.

There are three content areas:

1. Socialism: core ideas and principles
2. Differing views and tensions within socialism
3. Socialist thinkers and their ideas.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
1 Socialism: core ideas and principles	Core ideas and principles of socialism and how they relate to human nature, the state, society and the economy:
Key terminology	
Fraternity	• collectivism – to cover how collective human effort is both of greater practical value to the economy and moral value to society than the effort of individuals
Cooperation	• common humanity – to cover the nature of humans as social creatures with a tendency to co-operation, sociability and rationality, and how the individual cannot be understood without reference to society, as human behaviour is socially determined
Capitalism	• equality – is a fundamental value of socialism – to cover the disagreements among socialists about the nature of equality and how it is critical to the state, society, the economy and human nature
Common ownership	• social class – a group of people in society who have the same socioeconomic status – to cover the extent to which class impacts on socialists' views of society, the state and the economy
Communism	• workers' control – to cover the importance and the extent of control over the economy and/or state and how it is to be achieved.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
2 Differing views and tensions within socialism	The differing views and tensions within socialism:
Key terminology	
Evolutionary socialism	• revolutionary socialism – socialism can be brought about only by the overthrow of the existing political and societal structures
Marxism	• social democracy – an ideological view that wishes to humanise capitalism in the interests of social justice
Revisionism	• Third Way – a middle-ground alternative route to socialism and free-market capitalism.
Social justice	

Please note that content area 3 should focus on the key ideas given, rather than on the study of detailed biographical information on each thinker.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
3 Socialist thinkers and their ideas Key terminology Class consciousness Historical materialism Dialectic Keynesian economics	The key ideas of the following thinkers to exemplify the content from areas 1 and 2: Karl Marx (1818–83) and Friedrich Engels (1820–95) • The centrality of social class – the ideas of historical materialism, dialectic change and revolutionary class consciousness. • Humans as social beings – how nature is socially determined and how true common humanity can be expressed only under communism. Beatrice Webb (1858–1943) • ‘The inevitability of gradualness’ – the gradualist parliamentary strategy for achieving evolutionary socialism. • The expansion of the state – that this, and not the overthrow of the state, is critical in delivering socialism. Rosa Luxemburg (1871–1919) • Evolutionary socialism and revisionism – this is not possible as capitalism is based on an economic relationship of exploitation. • Struggle by the proletariat for reform and democracy – this creates the class consciousness necessary for the overthrow of the capitalist society and state. Anthony Crosland (1918–77) • The inherent contradictions in capitalism – does not drive social change and managed capitalism can deliver social justice and equality. • State-managed capitalism – includes the mixed economy, full employment and universal social benefits. Anthony Giddens (1938–) • The rejection of state intervention – acceptance of the free market in the economy, emphasis on equality of opportunity over equality, responsibility and community over class conflict. • The role of the state – is social investment in infrastructure and education not economic and social engineering.

Please note that key terminology is not exclusive to the given content area and applies across all three content areas. Definitions of key terminology are given in *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

Assessment information

- First assessment: June 2019.
- The assessment is 2 hours.
- The assessment is out of 84 marks.
- The assessment consists of **two** sections:
 - o Section A – Political Participation: this section is worth 60 marks
Students answer one source question requiring comparative analysis from a choice of two and one essay question from a choice of two. AO1, AO2 and AO3 are assessed.
 - o Section B – Core Political Ideas: this section is worth 24 marks
Students have a choice of two questions and they answer one.
AO1, AO2 and AO3 are assessed.

These questions will focus on content areas 1 and 2 and require students to use the key ideas of thinkers (content area 3) in their answers. These questions will cover either one core political idea or two core political ideas (1 socialism, 1 liberalism).

No other materials, for example a calculator, are required for this paper.

Sources

AO2 and AO3 require students to study and respond to 'political information'. In this qualification, this is carried out through the questions in Section A that use a source. These sources will be a single written (text) source only or a single source that combines both text and data (pie chart, tables, simple graphs such as a bar chart), all related in some way to UK politics.

Sources will be selected to ensure that they give students opportunities to bring in their own knowledge and understanding, to engage in comparative analysis and to evaluate by making judgements and drawing conclusions.

For each source, information relating to the context of the source is provided.

This information will not be discretely assessed, however it is provided to help students to engage with the information provided in the source.

Sample assessment materials

A sample paper and mark scheme for this paper can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 3 Advanced GCE in Politics Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* document.

Component 2: UK Government and Non-core Political Ideas

There are two sections within this component, UK Government and Political Ideas. Students study UK Government and one political idea from a choice of five from the Political Ideas section.

Overview

Politics is ultimately about people, but most political decisions are made by a branch of government whose roles and powers are determined by a set of rules: the constitution.

This component is fundamental to understanding the nature of UK government, since it enables students to understand where, how and by whom political decisions are made. The component also gives students a base of comparison to other political systems.

The component introduces students to the set of rules governing politics in the UK, the UK constitution, which is different in nature from most of the rest of the world. It further introduces students to the specific roles and powers of the different major branches of the government – legislative, executive, and judiciary – as well as the relationships and balance of power between them, and considers where sovereignty now lies within this system.

Students will explore the following key themes: the relative powers of the different branches of UK government; the extent to which the constitution has changed in recent years; the desirability of further change; and the current location of sovereignty within the UK political system.

UK Government

There are four content areas:

1. The constitution
2. Parliament
3. Prime Minister and executive
4. Relations between the branches.

Non-core Political Ideas

This section allows students to explore **one** of five additional political ideas. Students will learn about the core ideas and principles and how they apply in practice to human nature, the state, society and the economy, the divisions within each idea and their key thinkers.

The five non-core political ideas to choose from are:

1. Anarchism
2. Ecologism
3. Feminism
4. Multiculturalism
5. Nationalism.

Skills

- Students must comprehend and interpret political information in relation to areas of UK government and one non-core political idea.
- Students must fully understand, and critically analyse and evaluate areas of UK government and one non-core political idea.
- Students must identify parallels, connections, similarities and differences between content studied, providing a basis for comparing the UK with the USA and appreciating the UK's position in global politics.
- Students must construct and communicate arguments and explanations with relevance, clarity and coherence and draw reasoned conclusions about UK government and one non-core political idea.
- Students must develop knowledge and understanding of key political concepts. The content supports these skills by presenting the main content for learning in the right-hand side of the content tables.
- Students must use appropriate vocabulary. The content supports this skill by listing key terminology in each content area in the left-hand side of the content tables. The lists are to support teaching of the main content and help students to use appropriate vocabulary in assessment. Students should, therefore, familiarise themselves with the definitions of key terminology for each section, please also see *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

UK Government content

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
1 The constitution	1.1 The nature and sources of the UK Constitution, including: - an overview of the development of the Constitution through key historical documents: - Magna Carta (1215); Bill of Rights (1689); Act of Settlement (1701); Acts of Union (1707); Parliament Acts (1911 and 1949) - the nature of the UK Constitution: unentrenched, uncoded and unitary, and the 'twin pillars' of parliamentary sovereignty and the rule of law - the five main sources of the UK Constitution: statute law; common law; conventions; authoritative works, and treaties.
Key terminology	
Constitution Unentrenched (entrenched) Uncoded (coded) Unitary (federal) Parliamentary sovereignty The rule of law Statute law Common law Conventions Authoritative works Treaties Devolution	1.2 How the constitution has changed since 1997. - Under Labour 1997–2010: House of Lords reforms, electoral reform; devolution; Human Rights Act 1998; and the Supreme Court. - Under the Coalition 2010–15: Fixed Term Parliaments, Act 2011; further devolution to Wales. - Any major reforms undertaken by governments since 2015, including further devolution to Scotland (in the context of the Scottish Referendum).
	1.3 The role and powers of devolved bodies in the UK, and the impact of this devolution on the UK. - Devolution in England. - Scottish Parliament and Government. - Welsh Assembly and Government. - Northern Ireland Assembly and Executive.
	1.4 Debates on further reform. - An overview of the extent to which the individual reforms since 1997 listed in section 1.2 above should be taken further. - The extent to which devolution should be extended in England. - Whether the UK constitution should be changed to be entrenched and coded, including a bill of rights.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
2 Parliament	2.1 The structure and role of the House of Commons and House of Lords. • The selection of members of the House of Commons and House of Lords, including the different types of Peers. • The main functions of the House of Commons and House of Lords and the extent to which these functions are fulfilled.
Key terminology	
Parliament	
House of Commons	
House of Lords	
Confidence and supply	2.2 The comparative powers of the House of Commons and House of Lords. • The exclusive powers of the House of Commons. • The main powers of the House of Lords. • Debates about the relative power of the two Houses.
Salisbury Convention	
Parliamentary privilege	
Legislative bills	2.3 The legislative process. • The different stages a bill must go through to become law. • The interaction between the Commons and the Lords during the legislative process, including the Salisbury Convention.
Public bill committees	
Backbenchers	
Select committees	
Opposition	2.4 The ways in which Parliament interacts with the Executive. • The role and significance of backbenchers in both Houses, including the importance of parliamentary privilege. • The work of select committees. • The role and significance of the opposition. • The purpose and nature of ministerial question time, including Prime Minister's Questions.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
3 Prime Minister and Executive <i>Key terminology</i> Executive Cabinet Minister Government department Royal prerogative Secondary legislation Individual responsibility Collective responsibility Presidential government	3.1 The structure, role, and powers of the Executive. • Its structure, including Prime Minister, the Cabinet, junior ministers and government departments. • Its main roles, including proposing legislation, proposing a budget, and making policy decisions within laws and budget. • The main powers of the Executive, including Royal Prerogative powers, initiation of legislation and secondary legislative power.
	3.2 The concept of ministerial responsibility. • The concept of individual ministerial responsibility. • The concept of collective ministerial responsibility.
	3.3 The Prime Minister and the Cabinet. 3.3.1 The power of the Prime Minister and the Cabinet. • The factors governing the Prime Minister's selection of ministers. • The factors that affect the relationship between the Cabinet and the Prime Minister, and the ways they have changed, and the balance of power between the Prime Minister and the Cabinet. 3.3.2 The powers of the Prime Minister and the Cabinet to dictate events and determine policy. • Students must study the influence of one Prime Minister from 1945 to 1997 and one post-1997 Prime Minister. • Students may choose any pre-1997 and any post-1997 Prime Minister, provided that they study them in an equivalent level of detail, covering both events and policy, with examples that illustrate both control and a lack of control.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
4 Relations between the branches Key terminology Supreme Court Judicial neutrality Judicial independence Judicial review Elective dictatorship European Union (EU) Four freedoms (EU) Legal sovereignty Political sovereignty <i>Ultra vires</i>	4.1 The Supreme Court and its interactions with, and influence over, the legislative and policy-making processes. • The role and composition of the Supreme Court. • The key operating principles of the Supreme Court, including judicial neutrality and judicial independence and their extent. • The degree to which the Supreme Court influences both the Executive and Parliament, including the doctrine of <i>ultra vires</i> and judicial review. 4.2 The relationship between the Executive and Parliament. • The influence and effectiveness of Parliament in holding the Executive to account. • The influence and effectiveness of the Executive in attempting to exercise dominance over Parliament. • The extent to which the balance of power between Parliament and the Executive has changed. 4.3 The aims, role and impact of the European Union (EU) on the UK government. • The aims of the EU, including the 'four freedoms' of the single market, political and economic union, and the extent to which these have been achieved. • The impact of leaving the EU on UK Parliamentary sovereignty in relation to policy making. 4.4 The location of sovereignty in the UK political system. • The distinction between legal sovereignty and political sovereignty. • The extent to which sovereignty has moved between different branches of government. • Where sovereignty can now be said to lie in the UK.

Definitions of key terminology are given in *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

Non-core Political Ideas content

Anarchism option

Anarchism is an ideology which has at its heart the aim of liberating people from political domination and economic exploitation. Anarchism is defined by its rejection of the state and all forms of political authority.

There are three content areas for this option:

1. Anarchism: core ideas and principles
2. Different types of anarchism
3. Anarchist thinkers and their ideas.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
1 Anarchism: core ideas and principles	Core ideas and principles of anarchism and how they relate to human nature, the state, society and the economy:
Key terminology	
Power	• rejection of the state – the state is immoral as it rules by physical coercion and deceit, unjust in its defence of economic inequality and must be rejected due to its impact on human nature – to cover the arguments against the state, power and political participation and how the state can be overthrown
Authority	
Government	• liberty – is incompatible with any form of political authority in the state, society or the economy and is critical to human nature – to cover the differing views of liberty and human nature within anarchism
State	
Altruism	• anarchy is order – to cover how social order occurs naturally and spontaneously, emerging from human nature, and is the key to the belief in a peaceful, stable, stateless society
Autonomy	• economic freedom – the economy should be a space where free individuals can manage their own affairs without state ownership or regulation – to cover the different criticisms of existing economic systems and different ways economic freedom can be achieved
Direct action	• utopian – to cover the operation and benefits of an idealised society in order to develop a critique of existing society and the criticisms levelled against anarchism as unachievable and unrealistic.
Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
2 Different types of anarchism	The different types of anarchism:
Key terminology	
Syndicalism	• collectivist anarchism – committed to common ownership to nurture rational, altruistic and cooperative human nature: ◦ anarcho-communism ◦ mutualism ◦ anarcho-syndicalism
Direct democracy	
Solidarity	• individualist anarchism – committed to freedom where rational, autonomous, competitive and self-interested individuals can make judgements in their own best interests:
Mutualism	

Please note that content area 3 should focus on the key ideas given, rather than on the study of detailed biographical information on each thinker.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
3 Anarchist thinkers and their ideas Key terminology Collectivisation Mutual aid Insurrection	The key ideas of the following thinkers, to exemplify the content from areas 1 and 2: Max Stirner (1806-1856) • The self-interested and rational individual – is the centre of the moral universe and the state. • The future society will be the Union of Egoists (anarchy is order) – this will be brought about by insurrection, not overthrow of the state. Pierre-Joseph Proudhon (1809-1865) • Opposition to private property and collectivism – private property limits liberty and economic freedom and should be replaced by mutualism. • The rejection and overthrow of the state – via peaceful means. Mikhail Bakunin (1814-1876) • Propaganda by the deed – this would spark revolution and the state must be abolished as power is oppressive. • Strong belief in human sociability – the need to abolish private property and replace it with collectivisation. Peter Kropotkin (1842-1921) • The scientific basis for mutual aid – allows human nature to flourish. • Revolution to abolish the state and private property – utopian vision of the future society where anarchy is order. Emma Goldman (1869-1940) • The state is a cold monster – it should be rejected as it is immoral. • All forms of political participation in the state and society are corrupting and futile – so revolution, not reform, is the only option.

Please note that key terminology is not exclusive to the given content area and applies across all three content areas. Definitions of key terminology are given in *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

Ecologism option

Ecologism is a reaction against the process of industrialisation and urbanisation. It promotes sustainability and believes that a fulfilling existence needs to be based on a radical altering of our relationship with non-human nature and our social and political life.

There are three content areas for this option:

1. Ecologism: core ideas and principles
2. Different types of ecologism
3. Ecologist thinkers and their ideas.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
1 Ecologism: core ideas and principles	Core ideas and principles of ecologism and how they relate to human nature, the state, society and the economy:
Key terminology	
Industrialism	• ecology – to cover the extent to which the study of the relationship between living beings and the environment has implications for deep- and shallow-green views of the state, society and the economy
Consumerism	• holism – to cover the opposition to the mechanistic world view of post-Enlightenment science that dominates the state and society in its view of the non-human world and the economy
Sustainability	• environmental ethics – developing new moral standards and values for human relations with each other and the non-human world, which will underpin the state, society and economy – to cover the nature of ethics and how far they extend
Environmental consciousness	• environmental consciousness – a state of being where one's sense of self is fully realised by a deep identification with the non-human world – to cover the extent to which there needs to be a radical change in human nature and society
Green capitalism	• post-materialist and anti-consumerism – to cover the criticisms of materialism and consumerism and how to move beyond them
Mechanistic world view	• sustainability – the capacity of the ecological system to maintain its health over time – to cover the need for, type and way of delivering sustainability, which has implications for the state, society and the economy.
Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
2 Different types of ecologism	The different types of ecologism:
Key terminology	
Limits to growth	• deep green – environmental consciousness, ecocentrism and strong sustainability
Decentralisation	• shallow green – enlightened anthropocentrism and weak sustainability
Ecocentric	• social ecology – environmental degradation can be linked to existing social structures and sustainability is linked to radical social change
Anthropocentric	• eco-socialism

Please note that content area 3 should focus on the key ideas given, rather than on the study of detailed biographical information on each thinker.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
3 Ecologist thinkers and their ideas Key terminology Biodiversity Buddhist economics Biocentric equality	The key ideas of the following thinkers, to exemplify the content from areas 1 and 2: Aldo Leopold (1887–1948) • The land ethic – extends the community to include the non-human world and preserving the integrity, stability and beauty of the biotic community. • Conservation fails – as it is still based on an economic model rather than moving beyond economics to a new human-land relationship. Rachel Carson (1907–1964) • The state and society does not have the authority to dominate nature – the long-term effects of chemical pesticide use impact sustainability. • Nature should be seen holistically – it does not exist for the convenience of man. E. F. Schumacher (1911–1977) • Buddhist economics – economics as if people mattered, with the aim of the maximum of wellbeing with the minimum of consumption. • Traditional economics – based on the fallacy that goods are more important than humans and that materialism is more important than human creative activity. Murray Bookchin (1921–2006) • The environmental crisis emerges from existing social structures of oppression – so social structures and the state must be overthrown. • Lessons should be learned from ecology – the future should be built around decentralised societies, organised as a collection of self-sufficient communes. Carolyn Merchant (1936–) • The oppression and death of nature are linked to gender oppression – so radical, societal restructuring of gender relations is needed. • Opposition to the mechanistic, male view of science and nature – this dominates society as it is not holistic.

Please note that key terminology is not exclusive to the given content area and applies across all three content areas. Definitions of key terminology are given in *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

Feminism option

Feminism is an ideology based on the belief that society is characterised by unequal gender power and status. All forms of feminism are committed to advancing the social role of women, ensuring that the disadvantages they face can and should be overthrown.

There are three content areas for this option:

1. Feminism: ideas and principles
2. Different types of feminism
3. Feminist thinkers and their ideas.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
1 Feminism: ideas and principles	Core ideas and principles of feminism and how they relate to human nature, the state, society and the economy:
Key terminology	
Public sphere	• sex and gender – sex refers to biological differences between men and women, whereas gender refers to the different roles that society ascribes to men and women – to cover how feminists believe this distinction to be important in their analysis of society
Private sphere	• patriarchy – society, state and the economy are characterised by systematic, institutionalised and pervasive gender oppression – to cover how patriarchy is understood by different feminists and how different feminists view its importance
Essentialism	• the personal is political – the idea that all relationships, both in society and in private relationships, between men and women are based on power and dominance – to cover why feminists think this goes to the essence of patriarchy, and why some feminists believe this distinction is crucial and others believe it is dangerous
Gender stereotypes	• equality feminism and difference feminism – equality feminists seek equality for men and women in society, whereas difference feminists argue that men and women have a fundamentally different nature from one another – to cover the core differences between these two types of feminism and how significant they are • intersectionality – argues that black and working-class women's experiences of patriarchy in state, society and the economy are different from white, middle-class women – to cover the impact of this newer strand of feminism to wider feminist thinking.
Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
2 Different types of feminism	The different types of feminism:
Key terminology	
Discrimination	• liberal feminism – sees individualism as the basis of gender equality
Equality of opportunity	• socialist feminism – believes that gender inequality stems from economics and that capitalism creates patriarchy
Political equality	• radical feminism – believes that the biggest problem facing society is gender inequality
Legal equality	• post-modern feminism – argues that patriarchy manifests in different ways depending on a woman's race, class etc.
Reserve army of labour	
Gender equality	
Cultural feminism	
Reformist	

Please note that content area 3 should focus on the key ideas given, rather than on the study of detailed biographical information on each thinker.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
3 Feminist thinkers and their ideas Key terminology Otherness Equality and difference feminism Intersectionality	The key ideas of the following thinkers to exemplify the content from areas 1 and 2: Charlotte Perkins Gilman (1860–1935) • Sex and domestic economics are hand in hand – for women to survive, they have to depend on their sexuality and body in order to please their husbands. • Societal pressure – young girls are compelled to conform in society and prepare for motherhood by playing with toys and wearing clothes that are specifically designed for and marketed to them. Simone de Beauvoir (1908–1986) • Sex versus gender – ‘one is not born, but rather becomes, a woman’. • ‘Otherness’ – men are perceived as the ‘norm’ and women deviants from this norm. Kate Millett (1934–) • Family – undoing the traditional family was the key to true sexual revolution. • Portrayal of women in art and literature – she showed how patriarchal culture had produced writers and literary works that were degrading to women. Sheila Rowbotham (1943–) • Capitalism – women are forced to sell their labour to survive and use their labour to support their family under the capitalist system. • The family – not just an instrument for disciplining and subjecting women to capitalism but a place where men took refuge from alienation under a capitalist economy. bell hooks (1952–) • Women of colour – she brought the cultural concerns of women of colour into the mainstream feminist movement. • Intersectionality – the mainstream feminist movement had focused mostly on the plight of white, college-educated, middle/upper-class women who had no stake in the concerns of women of colour.

Please note that key terminology is not exclusive to the given content area and applies across all three content areas. Definitions of key terminology are given in *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

Multiculturalism option

Multiculturalism is concerned with the best way to respond to cultural and religious diversity and how to balance this diversity with civic unity. It focuses on the political accommodation of difference and how to integrate differing identities into an overarching, collective identity.

There are three content areas for this option:

1. Multiculturalism: ideas and principles
2. Different types of multiculturalism
3. Multiculturalist thinkers and their ideas.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
1 Multiculturalism: ideas and principles	Core ideas and principles of multiculturalism and how they relate to human nature, the state, society and the economy:
Key terminology	
Culture	
Formal equality	
Diversity	
Identity politics	
Tolerance	
	• politics of recognition – this is the positive endorsement and celebration of cultural differences – to cover how oppression/cultural marginalisation affects human nature and the importance of recognition for the human sense of self, which underpins integration and social cohesion • culture and identity – to cover how culture is critical to human nature and society as it shapes personal, political and social identity and why minority cultures should be protected, as well as criticisms of favouring minority cultures • minority rights – to cover why the state should and how it can address the specific needs of particular groups in society or the economy by granting special rights to them, based on their different needs as a culture, as well as criticisms of these rights • diversity – including different races and cultures in the state, society and the economy is possible, is positive and should be celebrated – to cover the different justifications for diversity, the different types of diversity and the criticisms of diversity.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
2 Different types of multiculturalism	The different types of multiculturalism, particularly the features of integration and segregation:
Key terminology	
Individualist integration	
Multicultural integration	
Assimilation	
Segregation	
Cosmopolitan integration	
	• liberal multiculturalism – a broad ideology that endorses cultural diversity, compatible with tolerance and personal autonomy within a liberal framework, and promotes civic unity in the public sphere • pluralist multiculturalism – a broad ideology where diversity is a value in its own right, all cultures are equal and cultural recognition is the basis for civic participation • cosmopolitan multiculturalism – diversity strengthens cultural hybridity, promoting global citizenship and undermining cultural identity as a driving force in society • the conservative criticism – there can be no diversity within unity.

Please note that content area 3 should focus on the key ideas given, rather than on the study of detailed biographical information on each thinker.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
3 Multiculturalist thinkers and their ideas Key terminology Positive discrimination Value pluralism Group differentiated rights Universalism	The key ideas of the following thinkers to exemplify the content from areas 1 and 2: Isaiah Berlin (1909–97) • Value pluralism – liberal views in society hold no more moral authority than illiberal beliefs, so the state and society need to move beyond shallow diversity. • Only in a liberal society, which respects liberty, can you value pluralism. Charles Taylor (1931–) • The politics of recognition – based on the universal right for all to have their identity recognised. • The politics of recognition is based on the equalisation of all rights and entitlements and the politics of difference. Bhikhu Parekh (1935–) • The rejection of the universalist liberalism – importance of the individual being culturally embedded. • The justifications for minority rights and deep diversity – cross-cultural dialogue can be transformative for majority and minority cultures, creating common citizenship. Tariq Modood (1952–) • Strong cultural identities are a good thing – they need a complement of a vibrant, national narrative that emerges from debate between cultures. • All four views of integration (assimilation, individualist, multiculturalism and cosmopolitanism) may be valid – provided it is the preferred choice of the individual or group and not imposed by the state or society. Will Kymlicka (1962–) • Group differentiated rights – provided by the state, including self-government rights, polyethnic rights and representation rights. • The justification for these rights – to be provided by the state and how they ensure full and equal participation for, and integration of, all cultures.

Please note that key terminology is not exclusive to the given content area and applies across all three content areas. Definitions of key terminology are given in *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

Nationalism option

Nationalism is the belief that nations are a timeless phenomenon. It is based on the belief that people have been attached to the practices connected with their heritage and seeks to continue them freely.

There are three content areas for this option:

1. Nationalism: ideas and principles
2. Different types of nationalism
3. Nationalist thinkers and their ideas.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
1 Nationalism: core ideas and principles	Core ideas and principles of nationalism and how they relate to human nature, the state, society and the economy:
Key terminology	• nations – people who identify themselves as a cohesive group based on shared values in society – to cover the idea that there are very different ways of defining a nation
Civic nationalism	• self-determination – belief that nations should decide how they are governed – to cover the idea of the nation as a genuine political community capable of self-government
Liberal internationalism	• nation-state – a nation that rules itself in its own state and controls its own economy – to cover the understanding that the nation-state, while supported by most nationalists, is not universally supported
Socialist internationalism	• culturalism – that nationalism is based on shared cultural societal values – to cover the idea that some forms of nationalism are grounded in more mystical, emotional ties and also to reflect on the darker side of nationalism
Ethnicity	• racialism – humankind can be meaningfully divided into separate 'races', which each possess different natures – to cover the view held by a very small group of nationalists who believe that nationhood is determined purely by biological factors • internationalism – the world should unite across boundaries to advance their common interests in society – to cover the idea that some forms of nationalism also have an internationalist perspective, whereas other internationalists reject nationalism.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
2 Different types of nationalism	The different types of nationalism and the extent to which they vary:
Key terminology	• liberal nationalism – seeks a world of autonomous nation-states
Rational	• conservative nationalism – exists to forge a sense of cohesion and unity within society
Progressive	• anti/post-colonialism – rejects colonial rule and seeks to have governance returned to the indigenous population
Regressive	• expansionist nationalism – rejects the right of all nations to self-determination, usually linked to chauvinism.
Inclusive nationalism	
Exclusive nationalism	
Chauvinistic nationalism	
Imperialism/colonialism	

Please note that content area 3 should focus on the key ideas given, rather than on the study of detailed biographical information on each thinker.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
3 Nationalist thinkers and their ideas <i>Key terminology</i> Volksgeist Integral nationalism Black nationalism	The key ideas of the following thinkers to exemplify the content from areas 1 and 2: Jean-Jacques Rousseau (1712–1778) • General will – that government should be based on the indivisible collective will of the 'community' and that nations have the right to govern themselves. • Civic nationalism – where the state is legitimate because it is based on the active participation of its citizens. Johann Gottfried von Herder (1744–1803) • Cultural nationalism – suggested that every nation was different, and that every nation had its own unique cultural character. • Volk – identified the Volk (the people) as the root of national culture and special nature (Volksgeist), which each nation should try to express. Giuseppe Mazzini (1805–1872) • Nationhood – believed that humans could express themselves only via their nation and that human freedom rested on the creation of one's own nation-state. • 'Action' – rejected intellectualism and rationalism, and created an idea known as 'thought and action'. Charles Maurras (1868–1952) • Integral nationalism – an intensely emotional form of nationalism where individuals were encouraged to submerge themselves into their nation. • Militarism – integral nationalism encourages nations to have a strong military ethos. Marcus Garvey (1887–1940) • Black pride – encouraged African people to be proud of their race and to see beauty in their own kind. • Pan-Africanism – that African people, in every part of the world, were one people and that they would never progress if they did not put aside their cultural and ethnic differences.

Please note that key terminology is not exclusive to the given content area and applies across all three content areas. Definitions of key terminology are given in *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

Assessment information

- First assessment: June 2019.
- The assessment is 2 hours.
- The assessment is out of 84 marks.
- The assessment consists of **two** sections.
 - Section A – UK Government: this section is worth 60 marks
Students answer one source question requiring comparative analysis from a choice of two and one essay question from a choice of two. AO1, AO2 and AO3 are assessed.
 - Section B – Non-core Political Ideas: this section is worth 24 marks
Students have a choice of two questions from the non-core idea they have studied and they answer one.
AO1, AO2 and AO3 are assessed.
These questions will focus on content areas 1 and 2 and require students to use the key ideas of thinkers (content area 3) in their answers.

No other materials, for example a calculator, are required for this paper.

Sources

AO2 and AO3 require students to study and respond to 'political information'. In this qualification, this is carried out through the questions in Section A that use a source. These sources will be a single written (text) source only or a single source that combines both text and data (pie chart, tables, simple graphs such as a bar chart), all related in some way to UK government.

Sources will be selected to ensure that they give students opportunities to bring in their own knowledge and understanding, to engage in comparative analysis and to evaluate by making judgements and drawing conclusions.

For each source, information relating to the context of the source is provided. This information will not be discretely assessed, however it is provided to assist students in engaging with the information provided in the source.

Synoptic assessment

Synoptic assessment requires students to work across different parts of a qualification and to show their accumulated knowledge and understanding of a topic or subject area.

Synoptic assessment enables students to show their ability to combine their skills, knowledge and understanding with breadth and depth of the subject.

This paper assesses synopticity in Section A in the non-source questions, which require students to draw on relevant knowledge and understanding from Component 1: UK politics and core political ideas.

Sample assessment materials

A sample paper and mark scheme for this paper can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 3*

Component 3: Comparative Politics

There are two optional sections within this component, Government and Politics of the USA and Global Politics. Students must study **one** of these.

Government and Politics of the USA

Overview

The USA has been considered by some to be a 'beacon of democracy'. As a world power, understanding the nature of US democracy, and the debates surrounding it, is crucial given the considerable impact that the USA has on UK, European and global politics.

Students will explore the US Constitution and the arguments surrounding this guiding document of US democracy. In learning about the key institutions of government in the USA and analysing the manner in which they achieve this power and exercise it over their citizens, students will judge ultimately whether 'liberty and justice for all' has been achieved in the USA. Students will be expected to highlight the debates on the nature of democracy in the USA and evaluate the extent to which it remains an issue.

The impact of the US government on the world beyond its borders is increasingly a feature of international politics. Students will begin to engage with this interaction by comparing and contrasting politics and institutions in the US with those in the UK. This will develop a wider understanding of politics as a discipline, underpinned by the theoretical concepts of comparative politics.

Content

There are six content areas:

1. The US Constitution and federalism
2. US Congress
3. US presidency
4. US Supreme Court and US civil rights
5. US democracy and participation
6. Comparative theories.

Skills

- Students must comprehend and interpret political information in relation to areas of US politics.
- Students must fully understand and critically analyse and evaluate areas of US politics.
- Students must identify parallels, connections, similarities and differences between content studied, providing a basis for comparing the UK with the US.
- Students must construct and communicate arguments and explanations with relevance, clarity and coherence and draw reasoned conclusions about US politics.
- Students must develop knowledge and understanding of key political concepts. The content supports these skills by presenting the main content for learning in the right-hand side of the content tables.
- Students must use appropriate vocabulary. The content supports this skill by listing key terminology in each content area. The lists are to support teaching of the main content and help students to use appropriate vocabulary in assessment. Students should, therefore, familiarise themselves with the definitions of key terminology for each section, please also see *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
1 US Constitution and federalism Key terminology Bipartisanship Checks and balances Codification Constitution Entrenchment Enumerated powers Federalism Limited government Principle Separation of powers	1.1 The nature of the US Constitution. • Vagueness of the document, codification and entrenchment. • The constitutional framework (powers) of the US branches of government. • The amendment process, including advantages and disadvantages of the formal process. 1.2 The key features of the US Constitution (as listed below) and an evaluation of their effectiveness today. • Federalism. • Separation of powers and checks and balances. • Bipartisanship. • Limited government. 1.3 The main characteristics of US federalism. • The nature of the federal system of government and its relationship with the states. 1.4 Interpretations and debates around the US Constitution and federalism. • The extent of democracy within the US Constitution, its strengths and weaknesses and its impact on the US government today. • The debates around the extent to which the USA remains federal today.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
2 US Congress <i>Key terminology</i> Congressional caucuses Divided government Filibuster Gridlock Incumbency Mid-term elections Oversight Partisanship Unanimous consent	2.1 The structure of Congress. • Bicameral nature, the membership of Congress and the election cycle. 2.1.1 The distribution of powers within Congress: • powers given to Congress in the Constitution, the exclusive powers of each House and the concurrent powers of Congress. 2.2 The functions of Congress. 2.2.1 Representation. • Congressional elections and the significance of incumbency. • Factors that affect voting behaviour within Congress: ◦ parties and caucuses, constituency, pressure groups and lobbyists. 2.2.2 Legislative. • The legislative process, including the strengths and weaknesses of this process. • The differences between the legislative process in each chamber. • The policy significance of Congress – impact and effectiveness of laws passed. 2.2.3 Oversight. • Factors that influence the relationship between Congress and the presidency. • The checks on the other branches of government and the extent of its institutional effectiveness. 2.3 Interpretations and debates around Congress. • Changing roles and powers of Congress and their relative importance, and debates about adequacy of its representative role. • Changing significance of parties in Congress. • Significance and effectiveness of the powers outlined in the Constitution.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
3 US presidency Key terminology Domestic politics Electoral mandate Executive branch Executive orders Imperial presidency Imperilled presidency Informal powers Powers of persuasion Unified Government	3.1 Formal sources of presidential power as outlined in the US Constitution and their use. • The role as the Head of State and as the Head of Government. The significance of these powers with reference to presidents since 1992.
	3.2 Informal sources of presidential power and their use. • The electoral mandate, executive orders, national events and the cabinet. • Powers of persuasion including the nature/characteristics of each president. • Executive Office of the President (EXOP), including the role of the National Security Council (NSC), Office of Management and Budget (OMB) and the White House Office (WHO). The significance of these powers with reference to presidents since 1992.
	3.3 The presidency. 3.3.1 Relationships between the presidency and the following institutions and why this varies: • Congress and the Supreme Court. 3.3.2 Limitations on presidential power and why this varies between presidents: • changing nature of power over their term in office • Congress, the Supreme Court and the Constitution • the election cycle and divided government. The significance of these limitations with reference to presidents since 1992.
	3.4 Interpretations and debates of the US presidency. • How effectively they have achieved their aims. • The imperial presidency. • The extent of presidential accountability to Congress. • The role and power of the president in foreign policy. With reference to presidents since 1992.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
4 US Supreme Court and civil rights	4.1 The nature and role of the Supreme Court. • The US Constitution. • The independent nature of the Supreme Court. • The judicial review process (<i>Marbury vs Madison 1803</i> and <i>Fletcher vs Peck 1810</i>).
Key terminology	
Conservative justice	
Imperial judiciary	
Judicial activism	
Judicial restraint	
Judicial review	
Liberal justice	
Living constitution	
Originalism	
Public policy	
Stare decisis	
Strict/loose constructionist	
Swing justice	
Constitutional rights	
Racial equality	
Affirmative action	
	4.2 The appointment process for the Supreme Court. • Strengths and weaknesses of the process. • Factors influencing the president's choice of nominee. • The current composition and ideological balance of the Court.
	4.3 The Supreme Court and public policy. • The impact of the Supreme Court on public policy in the US, with a range of examples, including examples post-2005. • Political significance debate: the role of judicial activism and judicial restraint and criticisms of each.
	4.4 The protection of civil liberties and rights in the US today. • Rights protected by the Constitution, by the Bill of Rights, by subsequent constitutional amendments and by rulings of the Supreme Court.
	4.5 Race and rights in contemporary US politics. • The methods, influence and effectiveness of racial rights campaigns and the impact on current domestic policy: - o voting rights, affirmative action and representation.
	4.6 Interpretations and debates of the US Supreme Court and civil rights. • The political versus judicial nature of the Supreme Court. • Living Constitution ideology as against originalism. • How effectively civil and constitutional rights have been upheld by the Supreme Court and the effectiveness of this protection. • The extent of their powers and the effectiveness of checks and balances. • The successes and failures of measures to promote equality, including affirmative action and immigration reform.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
5 US democracy and participation Key terminology Campaign finance Factions Invisible primary Political Action Committees (PACs) Party system Policy group Professional group Single interest group Soft/hard money Super PACs Religious right	5.1 Electoral systems in the USA. 5.1.1 Presidential elections and their significance. - The main processes to elect a US president, including the constitutional requirements, the invisible primary, primaries and caucuses, the role of National Party Conventions and the electoral college, and the resulting party system. - The importance of incumbency on a president seeking a second term. 5.1.2 Campaign finance. - The role of campaign finance and the current legislation on campaign finance, including McCain-Feingold reforms 2002 and <i>Citizens United vs FEC</i> 2010. 5.2 The key ideas and principles of the Democratic and Republican parties. 5.2.1 The distribution of power and changing significance of the parties: Democrats - progressive attitude on social and moral issues, including crime - greater governmental intervention in the national economy - government provision of social welfare. Republicans - conservative attitude on social and moral issues - more restricted governmental intervention in the national economy while protecting American trade and jobs - acceptance of social welfare but a preference for personal responsibility. 5.2.2 The current conflicts and tendencies and the changing power and influence that exist within the parties. - Democrats: liberals, moderates and conservatives. - Republicans: moderates, social conservatives and fiscal conservatives. 5.2.3 Coalition of supporters for each party. - Voters: how the following factors are likely to influence voting patterns and why, in relation to one recent presidential election campaign (since 2000) – race, religion, gender and education. 5.3 Interest groups in the USA – their significance, resources, tactics and debates about their impact on democracy. - The influence, methods and power of at least one single interest group, professional group or policy group.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
5 US democracy and participation (continued)	5.4 Interpretations and debates of US democracy and participation, including: • advantages and disadvantages of the electoral process and the Electoral College and the debate around reform • the role of campaign finance and difficulty in achieving effective reform • the role of incumbency in elections • the ways in which interest groups can influence the three branches of government and policy creation, including the role of PACs and Super PACs and their impact on democracy.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
6 Comparative approaches	6.1 Theoretical approaches – understanding of these three approaches and the different ways they explain similarities and differences between the government and politics of different countries. Rational • This approach focuses on individuals within a political system. • A rational approach suggests that such individuals will act rationally, choosing to act in a particular way as it will give them a beneficial outcome. Cultural • This approach focuses on groups within a political system – this could be voters, parties, pressure groups and so on. • A cultural approach suggests that the shared ideas, beliefs and values of these groups often determine the actions of individuals within them. Structural • This approach focuses on the institutions in a political system and the processes within them. • A structural approach suggests that political outcomes are largely determined by the formal processes laid out within a political system. 6.2 Similarities and differences in the UK and USA. 6.2.1 Compare and debate the following aspects of the UK and US Constitutions and the resulting impact on politics and government: • their nature (codified/uncodified) and their sources, provisions and principles, including separation of powers, checks and balances • the similarities and differences between the US federal system and the UK system of devolution. 6.2.2 The extent to which rational, cultural and structural approaches can be used to account for these similarities and differences.

Subject content	Students should gain knowledge and understanding of:
6 Comparative approaches <i>(continued)</i>	6.2.3 Compare and debate the following aspects of the UK and US legislative branches and their resulting impact on politics and government: • powers, strengths and weaknesses of each of the Houses • the extent to which each of the Houses are equal. 6.2.4 The extent to which rational, cultural and structural approaches can be used to account for these similarities and differences.
	6.2.5 Compare and debate the following aspects of the UK and US executive branches and their resulting impact on politics and government: • key similarities and differences between the role and powers of the US President and the UK Prime Minister and their impact on politics and government • extent of accountability to the US and UK legislature. 6.2.6 The extent to which rational, cultural and structural approaches can be used to account for these similarities and differences.
	6.2.7 Compare and debate the following aspects of the UK and US Supreme Courts and civil rights and their resulting impact on politics and government: • basis for and relative extent for their powers • relative independence of the Supreme Court in the US and UK • effectiveness of the protection of rights in each country • effectiveness of interest groups in the protection of civil rights in the USA and the UK. 6.2.8 The extent to which rational, cultural and structural approaches can be used to account for these similarities and differences.
	6.2.9 Compare and debate the following aspects of the UK and US democracy and participation, and their resulting impact on politics and government: • the different nature of the party systems (two-party and multi-party) • degree of internal unity within parties • the policy profiles of the two main parties in each country • debates around campaign finance and party funding • the relative power, methods and influence of pressure groups. 6.2.10 The extent to which rational, cultural and structural approaches can be used to account for these similarities and differences.

Definitions of key terminology are given in *Appendix 2: Key terminology glossary*.

Global Politics

Overview

We live in a complex world with significant challenges, including global terrorism, poverty, economic instability, weapons proliferation, failing states and environmental degradation. These challenges require global co-operation if they are to be resolved.

Global politics gives students an opportunity to develop an understanding of the local, national, international and global dimensions of political activity. It also gives them the opportunity to explore the political issues that affect all of us. Students will gain understanding of abstract political concepts through grounding them in contemporary real-world examples and case studies that will develop an international awareness and knowledge of multiple perspectives.

Global politics encourages discussion and debate and requires students to study and present different global perspectives, as well as interpreting competing and contestable claims. The key mainstream perspectives on global politics are liberalism and realism, and students will be expected to understand how these perspectives are applied throughout all elements of the global politics content.

Content

There are six content areas:

1. The state and globalisation
2. Global governance: political and economic
3. Global governance: human rights and environmental
4. Power and developments
5. Regionalism and the European Union